> There are two kinds of infidels—one who has not professed the Faith, and one who has professed it. The former fights against us because we have professed the Islamic Faith. The latter will never fight against us because he has become our brother and entered our religion through professing the Faith. However, if he (the latter) is going astray, we will talk to him, persuade him to come to the way of religion. As long as he does not raise his hand against us, we will not raise ours against him. We will consider him wrong and misguided, and say that he is committing sins of un-belief (kufr) and associationism (shirk). But we will not declare war against him. Because if we declare war against those who have professed Faith, we cannot do war with those who haven't.[32]

He also made clear that Lashkar believes there is an 'essential difference between the utter brutalities and atrocities inflicted on the Kashmiri Muslims by the savage Hindus and the disregard for law and order which is a common scene in Pakistan and which is surely pitiable.' Thus, while appropriate to 'press the Pakistani rulers to enforce Islam' it is incorrect to directly fight against them since that would mean a cessation of jihad against the Hindu occupiers in order to 'set to killing our own brothers who declare their belief in the Islamic creed.'[33] In other words, Lashkar's prohibition against waging a jihad against Muslim rulers stems not only from the fact that it is considered doctrinally unacceptable as long as those rulers profess belief in Islam. It is also based on priorities and strategic calculation. Lashkar members were reportedly obligated during training to promise never to turn their guns on the state or use their martial skills within Pakistan.[34] Several militants confirmed this precept was drilled into them during training.[35] However, one of their number also admitted that debates often took place about whether to break with the prohibition against attacking the Pakistani state; a fact that was later confirmed by a high-ranking Jamaat-ul-Dawa official close to Hafiz Saeed.[36] These debates took place during the late 1990s and this decade, primarily coinciding with periods when Pakistan was restraining Lashkar's jihadi activities abroad. However support for these activities never ceased, and the leadership continued to direct the group's militant energies outward.